

05 May 2026 23:37:52 ET | 13 pages

Lumentum Holdings Inc (LITE.O)

Margin Outperformance Is the Highlight

CITI'S TAKE

LITE was down 3% after market close despite better-than-expected Jun-Q guide coupled with promising management comments on growing AI demand across its main EML businesses but also across its emerging AI businesses such as transceivers, CPO and OCS. LITE's 560bps QoQ Mar-Q non-GAAP GM expansion remains the highlight of the quarter as the metric benefitted from favorable mix, pricing increases and yield improvements. We mostly keep our sales estimates intact in FY2026E/FY2027E/FY2028E and maintain our Buy rating and TP to \$1,100, using a consistent 40x forward PE applied to a discounted back FY2028E EPS of ~\$30.

Mar-Q Recap — LITE reported Mar-Q revs/non-GAAP (NG) EPS of \$808M/\$2.37 vs. our \$805M/\$2.25 and Street's (FactSet) \$810M/\$2.26. Non-GAAP Gross margin came 460bps above street's 43.3% estimate as it benefited from revenue volume, favorable mix, pricing increases and yield improvements. Management is well on track to reaching 50%+ GM levels.

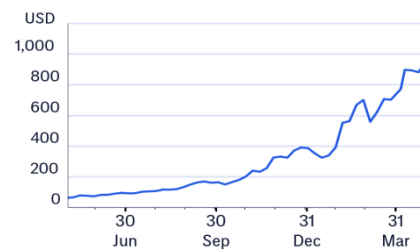
Jun-Q — The company guided to a robust Jun-Q revenue/NG EPS of \$985M (at MP) vs. our \$961M and Street's \$918M. The company guided non-GAAP OM to 35% to 36% vs. Citi's 33% and Street's 32%. NG EPS was guided to be \$2.95 at MP, 10% above Street's estimates.

Buy

Price (05 May 26 17:30)	US\$939.00
Target price	US\$1,100.00
Expected share price return	17.1%
Expected dividend yield	0.0%
Expected total return	17.1%
Market Cap	US\$67,045M

Price Performance

(RIC: LITE.O, BB: LITE US)



EPS (US\$)	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	FY	FC Cons
2025A	0.18A	0.42A	0.57A	0.88A	2.06A	2.06A
2026E	1.10A	1.67A	2.37A	2.97E	8.40E	7.61E
Previous	1.10A	1.67A	2.25E	3.04E	8.18E	na
2027E	3.64E	4.29E	5.41E	6.66E	20.03E	15.92E
Previous	3.64E	4.42E	5.47E	6.35E	19.96E	na
2028E	7.30E	7.55E	7.75E	7.75E	30.28E	23.35E
Previous	7.11E	7.38E	7.61E	7.91E	29.95E	na

Source: Company Reports and dataCentral, Citi Research. FC Cons: First Call Consensus.

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See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations.

LITE.O: Fiscal year end 30-Jun						Price: US\$939.00; TP: US\$1,100.00; Market Cap: US\$67,045m; Recomm: Buy					
Profit & Loss (US\$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	Valuation ratios	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Sales revenue	1,359	1,645	2,995	6,103	8,872	PE (x)	na	na	na	46.9	31.0
Cost of sales	-1,108	-1,185	-1,765	-3,123	-4,298	PB (x)	66.0	57.6	74.0	30.7	16.5
Gross profit	252	460	1,231	2,980	4,574	EV/EBITDA (x)	na	na	75.0	25.1	15.4
Gross Margin (%)	18.5	28.0	41.1	48.8	51.6	FCF yield (%)	-0.2	-0.2	0.2	0.6	2.1
EBITDA (Adj)	132	214	921	2,748	4,391	Dividend yield (%)	na	na	na	na	na
EBITDA Margin (Adj) (%)	9.7	13.0	30.8	45.0	49.5	Payout ratio (%)	0	0	0	0	0
Depreciation	-111	-104	-158	-338	-491	ROE (%)	-47.3	-0.9	37.6	72.3	58.0
Amortisation	0	0	0	0	0	Cashflow (US\$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
EBIT (Adj)	29	160	883	2,415	3,906	EBITDA	-251	-88	674	2,263	3,857
EBIT Margin (Adj) (%)	2.1	9.7	29.5	39.6	44.0	Working capital	139	-315	-283	-890	-351
Net interest	-34	-22	-25	-25	-25	Other	137	529	214	-35	-291
Associates	0	0	0	0	0	Operating cashflow	25	126	605	1,337	3,215
Non-Op/Except/Other Adj	-401	-345	-314	-475	-525	Capex	-133	-231	-394	-786	-1,143
Pre-tax profit	-406	-207	545	1,915	3,356	Net acq/disposals	19	99	-139	0	0
Tax	-141	198	-116	-402	-705	Other	0	48	0	0	0
Extraord./Min.Int./Pref.div.	0	0	0	0	0	Investing cashflow	-114	-84	-534	-786	-1,143
Reported net profit	-547	-9	429	1,513	2,651	Dividends paid	0	0	0	0	0
Net Margin (%)	-40.2	-0.5	14.3	24.8	29.9	Financing cashflow	-333	42	306	0	0
Core NPAT	61	146	759	1,987	3,248	Net change in cash	-422	84	377	551	2,072
Per share data	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	Free cashflow to s/holders	-108	-105	211	551	2,072
Reported EPS (\$)	-8.07	-0.13	4.74	15.25	24.71						
Core EPS (\$)	0.91	2.06	8.40	20.03	30.28						
DPS (\$)	0	0	0	0	0						
CFPS (\$)	0.36	1.77	6.70	13.48	29.97						
FCFPS (\$)	-1.60	-1.47	2.34	5.56	19.32						
BVPS (\$)	14.22	16.30	12.69	30.59	56.92						
Wtd avg ord shares (m)	67.7	71.2	90.4	99.2	107.3						
Wtd avg diluted shares (m)	67.7	71.2	90.4	99.2	107.3						
Growth rates	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E						
Sales revenue (%)	-23.1	21.0	82.1	103.8	45.4						
EBIT (Adj) (%)	-91.4	448.3	451.3	173.6	61.7						
Core NPAT (%)	-80.5	138.4	418.4	161.8	63.5						
Core EPS (%)	-80.1	126.6	308.4	138.6	51.2						
Balance Sheet (US\$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E						
Cash & cash equiv.	887	877	1,247	1,798	3,870						
Accounts receivables	195	250	568	1,124	1,348						
Inventory	398	470	830	1,532	1,798						
Net fixed & other tangibles	669	975	1,223	1,672	2,323						
Goodwill & intangibles	1,673	1,526	1,492	1,492	1,492						
Financial & other assets	110	120	125	125	125						
Total assets	3,932	4,219	5,485	7,743	10,957						
Accounts payable	126	225	435	803	942						
Short-term debt	0	11	1,079	1,079	1,079						
Long-term debt	2,503	2,563	2,165	2,165	2,165						
Provisions & other liab	345	286	310	310	310						
Total liabilities	2,975	3,084	3,989	4,357	4,496						
Shareholders' equity	957	1,135	1,496	3,386	6,461						
Minority interests	0	0	0	0	1						
Total equity	957	1,135	1,496	3,386	6,462						
Net debt (Adj)	1,616	1,696	1,997	1,445	-627						
Net debt to equity (Adj) (%)	168.8	149.5	133.4	42.7	-9.7						

For definitions of the items in this table, please click [here](#).

Figure 1. P&L Estimate Changes

Key Financial Data -- Income Statement	FY25 Jun-25	Old FY26E Jun-26	New FY26E Jun-26	Old FY27E Jun-27	New FY27E Jun-27	Old FY28E Jun-28	New FY28E Jun-28
(\$M), except per share							
Revenue (\$M)	1,645	2,965	2,995	6,103	6,103	8,872	8,872
YY	21.0%	80.3%	82.1%	105.8%	103.8%	45.4%	45.4%
		0.0%	1.0%				
Gross Margin - GAAP	28.0%	38.3%	41.1%	45.4%	48.8%	48.7%	51.6%
Gross Margin (ex-1, ex-amort, inc-SBC)	34.7%	42.8%	45.5%	47.6%	51.0%	50.2%	53.0%
RD % sales	15.6%	9.0%	9.9%	6.2%	6.4%	5.0%	5.0%
SG&A % sales	9.4%	5.9%	6.1%	5.0%	5.0%	4.0%	4.0%
OpEx non GAAP % Sales	25.0%	14.9%	16.0%	11.2%	11.4%	9.0%	9.0%
R&D non GAAP	256	266	296	379	391	444	444
SG&A non GAAP	155	175	184	305	305	355	355
OpEx (GAAP)	675	679	725	1,041	1,060	1,206	1,213
OpEx (non GAAP)	411	441	480	684	697	798	798
Operating Income non GAAP	160.1	828.9	882.6	2,223.9	2,415.0	3,657.8	3,905.8
Operating Margin non-GAAP	9.7%	28.0%	29.5%	36.4%	39.6%	41.2%	44.0%
Interest Expense	(22.2)	(24.6)	(24.5)	(25.2)	(25.2)	(25.2)	(25.2)
Other Income	30.2	56.7	63.2	40.0	20.0	40.0	20.0
Pretax Income non GAAP	175.3	847.2	902.5	2243.9	2423.0	3677.8	3913.8
Tax Rate non GAAP	16.5%	17.8%	15.9%	18.0%	18.0%	17.0%	17.0%
Share Count	71.2	85.1	90.4	92.2	99.2	101.9	107.3
EPS (ex-1, inc-SBC, ex-amort)	\$2.06	\$8.18	\$8.40	\$19.96	\$20.03	\$29.95	\$30.28
Consensus Sales			\$2,922		\$5,171		\$7,690
Consensus EPS non GAAP			\$7.81		\$16.88		\$27.27

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Source: Citi Research, FactSet, Company Reports

Bull/Bear: Lumentum Holdings Inc (LITE.O)

US\$1,500.00
▲ 60% Upside

US\$1,100.00
▲ 17% Upside

US\$500.00
▼ 47% Downside



Spread 106pp
Current Price and expected returns (upside/downside) as of 05 May 2026

BULL Assumptions

- Sustained AI sales drives sales and EPS faster-than-previously expected.
- Faster-than-expected ESP growth amid new management's effort to drive margins.
- 45x PE with \$40 FY2028 EPS discounted back.

BASE Assumptions

- Halo effect on AI helps expand multiple.
- Strong execution by new management to drive margins and EPS expansion.

BEAR Assumptions

- Inability to achieve margin targets drives EPS lower.
- Frontloaded AI demand.
- 30x PE with ~\$17 FY2028E EPS discounted back.

Lumentum Holdings Inc

Company description

Lumentum Holdings Inc. is a leader in optical and photonic market which delivers essential products to various end-markets including cloud, AI/ML, telecommunications, consumer, and industrial. LITE specifically focuses in two end-market focused reportable segments, Cloud & Networking and Industrial Tech.

Investment strategy

We are Buy-rated on LITE. We believe that the stock's multiple will benefit from the AI appeal while its fundamentals should expand on new management's strong execution and focus on profitability.

Valuation

Our 40x P/E multiple is a 14% premium vs the current 35x the current forward P/E average of AI optics peers. We model LITE to grow its EPS between 2025-2028E 2-3x faster. Therefore, on an earnings growth adjusted basis, we think a higher P/E multiple vs peers is justified. Our TP on LITE is \$1100.

Risks

Downside risks to the achievement of our target price include: 1) increased competition on AI leads to limited market share growth and limited revenue upside, 2) Frontloaded or slower-than-expected AI ramp affecting EML ramp, and 3) Slower than expected adoption of LITE CPO and OCS new products.

Upside risks to the achievement of our target price include: 1) gaining share in AI market through new products on the AI transceivers, CPO and OCS fronts 2) quicker and stronger adoption of AI workloads, and 3) faster-than-expected margin expansion.

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Appendix A-1

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IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES

Lumentum Holdings Inc (LITE)

Ratings and Target Price History Fundamental Research

Analyst: Papa Sylla



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	29-Aug-25 07:09:17	*1	*165.00	132.81
2	05-Nov-25 07:17:32	1	*240.00	232.75

*Indicates Change

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
3	22-Jan-26 16:00:38	1	*450.00	354.49
4	04-Feb-26 06:53:24	1	*560.00	465.54

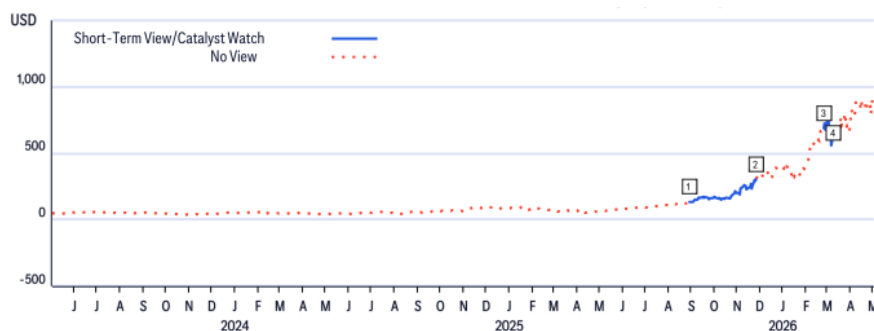
	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
5	24-Feb-26 19:04:05	1	*800.00	688.27
6	20-Apr-26 22:36:14	1	*1,100.00	895.11

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Lumentum Holdings Inc (LITE)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Papa Sylla



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	29-Aug-25 03:09:17	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	132.81
2	27-Nov-25 11:04:00	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	308.28

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
3	24-Feb-26 14:04:05	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	688.27
4	09-Mar-26 16:14:36	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	640.69

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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Data current as of 01 Apr 2026	12 Month Rating			Catalyst Watch		
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